# Message from the Program Co-Chairs

## IRI 2026

Greetings from IEEE IRI 2026!

On behalf of the Organizing Committee, we warmly welcome you to IEEE IRI 2026, the 27th IEEE International Conference on Information Reuse and Integration for Data Science, to be held from July 31 to August 2, 2026, in Seattle, Washington, USA, on the campus of the University of Washington Bothell. Located in one of the world's leading centers for technology, research, and innovation, the Seattle area offers an inspiring setting for IRI 2026. We are pleased to present a stimulating technical program, an engaging conference experience, and a welcoming platform for networking and collaboration.

IEEE IRI 2026 is honored to feature three distinguished keynote speakers. Bhavani Thuraisingham of The University of Texas at Dallas will present “AI for Cyber and Cyber for AI” on Friday, July 31, 2026, from 8:20 to 9:30 AM. Roger Barga of the University of Washington will present “Beyond Models: The Real Data Transformation Behind Generative AI” on Saturday, August 1, 2026, from 8:20 to 9:30 AM. John Y. Choe of the University of Washington, Seattle, will present “Can Artificial Intelligence Solve Longstanding Challenges in Information Reuse and Integration in Public-Private Partnerships?” on Sunday, August 2, 2026, from 8:20 to 9:30 AM. Together, these keynotes examine the relationship between artificial intelligence and cybersecurity, the data transformation behind generative AI, and the role of trustworthy socio-technical data ecosystems in enabling information reuse and integration across public-private partnerships.

Information reuse and integration aim to maximize the value of data, information, and knowledge through effective representation, reuse, and integration. These foundations are increasingly important as artificial intelligence, data science, software systems, cybersecurity, healthcare, multimedia, and other application domains become more interconnected and data intensive. For more than a quarter of a century, IEEE IRI has served as an internationally recognized forum for advancing the state of the art and practice in these areas. IRI 2026 continues this tradition by highlighting innovative research, practical applications, and forward-looking perspectives that address both established challenges and new directions.

The IEEE IRI 2026 conference received 232 paper submissions. Each submission underwent a rigorous peer-review process conducted by members of the international Program Committee and additional reviewers. A total of 64 full research papers were accepted, corresponding to a full-paper acceptance rate of approximately 27.6%. The technical program also includes high-quality industry and application papers, posters, demonstrations, and selected invited contributions. We sincerely thank all authors for choosing IEEE IRI 2026 as the venue for presenting their work, and we are deeply grateful to the program committee members and reviewers for their careful evaluations, constructive feedback, and professional service.

This year, we have two workshops that focus on emerging issues related to the IRI themes: (1) Artificial Intelligence for HealthCare (AIHC 2026), and (2) Empirical Methods for Recognizing Inference in Text (EM-RITE 2026). The selection of papers for these workshops was conducted separately from the main conference. We thank the workshop organizers, authors, and reviewers for contributing focused forums that complement and enrich the main technical program.

We extend our deep appreciation to the members of the IRI 2026 Organizing Committee. We thank the Poster Co-Chairs, Xiaoyu Jin (Google, USA), Sandeep Reddivari (University of North Florida, USA), and Fei Zhao (The University of Alabama at Birmingham, USA); the Workshop Co-Chairs, Ankit Agrawal (Saint Louis University, USA) and Enoch Solomon (Virginia Commonwealth University, USA); the Finance and Registration Co-Chairs, Yongjin Lu (Oakland University, USA) and Zedong Peng (University of Montana, USA); the Publication Co-Chairs, Min-Yuh Day (National Taipei University, Taiwan) and Truong X. Tran (Pennsylvania State University, USA); the Test-of-Time Award Co-Chairs, Jianquan Liu (NEC, Japan) and Danda B. Rawat (Howard University, USA); the Publicity Co-Chairs, Mohammed Ouali (Adrian College, USA), Xiaohong Chen (East China Normal University, China), Xin Chen (Governors State University, USA), Wooyoung Kim (University of Washington Bothell, USA), Andrew McIntyre (Acadia University, Canada), Wentao Wang (Oracle, USA), and Luntian Mou (Beijing University of Technology, China); and the Best Paper Committee Chair, Guimu Guo (Rowan University, USA).

We also express our heartfelt thanks to General Chair Shu-Ching Chen (University of Missouri-Kansas City, USA), the Steering Committee, and all volunteers for their leadership, guidance, and sustained support throughout the organization of the conference. We gratefully acknowledge our sponsors, especially IEEE TCMC, whose support helps make IEEE IRI 2026 a high-quality, inclusive, and diverse experience for all participants. We continue to honor the enduring contributions of Honorary General Chair Stuart Rubin, whose leadership and commitment have been integral to the IRI community since its beginning. The success of IEEE IRI 2026 reflects the commitment and teamwork of the entire community. We look forward to welcoming you to Seattle and wish you an enjoyable and rewarding conference experience.

**Program Co-Chairs**
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